RDG-P6 · PRÁCTICA 01

Gapped text

Hoja 01 · Crónica histórica · dificultad 1 de 4

7 huecos (37–43) · 8 párrafos (A–H), uno sobrante · 2 puntos por hueco · tiempo orientativo: 18 minutos · sin consultar la teoría

You are going to read an extract from a magazine article about a lighthouse. Seven paragraphs have been removed from the extract. Choose from the paragraphs **A–H** the one which fits each gap (37–43). There is one extra paragraph which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

The rock that ate lighthouses

For more than three centuries, a reef off Plymouth has been the proving ground of British lighthouse engineering.

Some fourteen miles south-west of Plymouth, a ragged line of rocks breaks the surface of the English Channel. At high water the Eddystone reef all but disappears, and for centuries ships making for the shelter of Plymouth Sound discovered it only when they struck it. By the end of the seventeenth century, with trade through the port growing year by year, the case for a light on the reef was obvious to everyone. What nobody could supply was a way of building one on a rock that the sea swept clean in every winter gale.

37 _____

Progress was painfully slow. Work was possible only in the summer months, and only on days calm enough to land, so that the first season's labour amounted to little more than twelve holes drilled into the rock to anchor the foundations. In 1697 a French privateer seized Winstanley at the site and carried him off to France, where Louis XIV ordered his release, reportedly remarking that France was at war with England, not with humanity. By November 1698 a light was burning on the reef for the first time.

38 _____

So confident was Winstanley in the rebuilt tower that he is said to have wished to be inside it during 'the greatest storm that ever was'. In November 1703 he had his wish. He had gone out to the reef to supervise repairs when the worst storm in recorded British history swept in from the Atlantic. When it had passed, nothing remained on the rock but a few twisted iron stumps. Of Winstanley and the men with him, no trace was ever found.

39 _____

Simplicity served it well against the water. For almost half a century the cone stood unmoved through every winter the Channel could throw at it. Its weakness lay elsewhere. On a December night in 1755 the keeper on watch found the lantern in flames, and since every drop of water had to be hauled up from the sea in buckets, the three men on the rock could do little but retreat down the tower as the fire followed them.

40 _____

Hall's ordeal made him briefly famous, but it was the loss of a second tower in little more than fifty years that alarmed the lighthouse's owners. On the advice of the Royal Society, the commission went to John Smeaton, a maker of scientific instruments from Leeds who had never built anything in the sea. Smeaton began not with the tower but with the problem, and found his answer in the shape of an oak: broad at the base and tapering upwards, the form that lets a tree stand through gales that bring down buildings.

41 _____

It was the shape and the dovetailing together that made Smeaton's tower so hard to shift. Within decades it had become the model for rock lighthouses around the world, and its designer is often described as the father of civil engineering. Yet when the tower finally had to go, the fault was not its own. In the 1870s inspectors found that the rock beneath it was being worn away, so that every large wave set the whole structure trembling.

42 _____

Its predecessor was not simply left to the waves. The upper part of Smeaton's tower was taken down stone by stone and rebuilt on Plymouth Hoe, where it still stands as a memorial, painted in red and white bands. The lower courses proved too solid to remove and were left where they were. They can still be seen beside the newer tower, a stump of granite that has outlasted every storm since 1759.

43 _____

Winstanley, whose first season on the reef produced twelve holes in the rock, would have recognised that proviso. Three centuries of engineering have changed almost everything about the Eddystone light except the conditions in which it has to be built and kept. Each of its four towers was, in its way, an argument about how to survive them, and the approach that won was the plainest: give the waves as little as possible to hold on to, and let the weight of stone do the rest.

A The oldest of them, Henry Hall, was ninety-four. As he stood throwing water up at the blaze, molten lead from the lantern roof poured down onto his upturned face and, he insisted afterwards, into his open mouth. The doctor who treated him ashore did not believe a word of it. Hall died twelve days later, and the post-mortem found a flat lump of lead in his stomach.

B The remedy was to start again on a neighbouring rock. The new tower, designed by James Douglass, engineer-in-chief of Trinity House, was more than twice as tall as Smeaton's and was completed in 1882. Yet it owed almost everything to the older design: the curving profile, the dovetailed granite and the solid stone of its lower courses.

C It did not burn for long without trouble. Over its first winter the waves broke so high that the lantern was often buried in spray, and its light lost to the very ships it was meant to warn. Winstanley's answer was characteristically extravagant. He enlarged the whole structure, raising it higher and adding galleries, a crane and a profusion of ornamental ironwork.

D Winstanley lost no time in turning his achievement to account. He engraved a detailed picture of the finished tower, ornate galleries and all, and copies circulated widely among people who would never see the reef. For a few years the lighthouse was almost as famous as the eccentric who had built it.

E He was equally original in his choice of materials. In place of timber he used granite and Portland stone, each block cut ashore to fit its neighbours like the pieces of a puzzle, so that every course was locked to the one below. To bind them he developed a lime mortar that would set under water. The tower was first lit in October 1759.

F The man who finally tried was not an engineer at all. Henry Winstanley was an engraver and something of a showman, whose house in Essex was crammed with trick furniture designed to alarm his guests. He also owned ships, and two of them had been wrecked on the Eddystone. In 1696 he set out for the reef.

G The Douglass tower is still in service, although nobody has lived in it since 1982, when the light was automated and the last keepers came ashore. A helicopter pad built above the lantern now brings out the engineers who maintain it, on days when the weather allows, which on the Eddystone is still by no means every day.

H The next attempt came from an equally unlikely quarter. John Rudyerd was a London silk merchant with no training in engineering, but he grasped what his predecessor had not: that anything projecting from a tower gave the sea something to grip. His tower, completed in 1709, was a plain cone of timber, weighted with courses of stone and as smooth as he could make it.

Hoja de respuestas

Marca una sola letra por hueco; cada letra se usa una vez como máximo. Al corregir, 2 puntos por acierto; los errores no restan. Anota también el tiempo empleado: el objetivo en el examen son unos 18 minutos.

Nº	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	Puntos
37	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
38	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
39	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
40	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
41	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
42	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
43	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
							Total		**/ 14**

Párrafo sobrante: _____ (no puntúa; sirve para comprobar). Tiempo empleado: _____ minutos.

SOLUCIONES

2 puntos por acierto. Cada solución explica qué une el párrafo con lo de antes (←) y con lo de después (→), con citas de los dos lados; cuando hay un párrafo tentador, por qué falla; y, al final, por qué el sobrante no entra en ningún hueco. Los números de sección remiten a RDG-P6_Teoria_v1.

Clave rápida

Nº	Clave	Empieza	Teoría
37	**F**	The man who finally tried was not…	§4.1 · §3.4
38	**C**	It did not burn for long without…	§4.1 · §4.4
39	**H**	The next attempt came from an equally…	§4.1 · §3.1
40	**A**	The oldest of them, Henry Hall, was…	§4.1 · §3.4
41	**E**	He was equally original in his choice…	§4.1 · §4.4
42	**B**	The remedy was to start again on…	§3.2 · §4.1
43	**G**	The Douglass tower is still in service…	§3.4 · §4.1
—	**D**	Winstanley lost no time in turning his… *(sobrante)*	§5.1 · §3.1

Explicación por hueco

37 • F • *The man who finally tried was not an engineer…*

← Con lo anterior. El texto base termina con un problema sin resolver: What nobody could supply was a way of building one. F empieza respondiendo a esa carencia: The man who finally tried. Además, F presenta a Winstanley con nombre completo y descripción (Henry Winstanley was an engraver and something of a showman), así que tiene que ir antes de cualquier párrafo que lo nombre solo por el apellido.

→ Con lo siguiente. F termina con el comienzo de la obra (he set out for the reef), y el párrafo siguiente cuenta cómo avanzaba: Progress was painfully slow. Ese párrafo ya nombra a Winstanley por el apellido (seized Winstanley at the site), lo que confirma que la presentación va justo antes.

Tentador: H. The next attempt y his predecessor presuponen un intento anterior, y en este punto del texto nadie lo ha intentado todavía.

Teoría: §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás · §3.4 Progresión temática

38 • C • *It did not burn for long without trouble.*

← Con lo anterior. El párrafo anterior acaba con la luz encendida por primera vez: By November 1698 a light was burning on the reef for the first time. C retoma esa luz con un pronombre y el mismo verbo: It did not burn for long without trouble.

→ Con lo siguiente. C cuenta que Winstanley amplió la torre (He enlarged the whole structure), y el párrafo siguiente presupone esa reforma: So confident was Winstanley in the rebuilt tower. El participio rebuilt recoge enlarged con otra palabra (§4.4).

Tentador: D. Encaja por detrás: tras la primera luz, Winstanley lost no time in turning his achievement to account suena natural. Pero falla por delante: D no habla de ninguna reforma, y the rebuilt tower se queda sin antecedente.

Teoría: §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás · §4.4 Cadenas léxicas

39 · H · *The next attempt came from an equally unlikely quarter.*

← Con lo anterior. El párrafo anterior termina con la destrucción de la torre y la muerte de su constructor: Of Winstanley and the men with him, no trace was ever found. H empieza con The next attempt y llama a Winstanley his predecessor. Además, equally unlikely remite a la presentación de Winstanley en el hueco 37: was not an engineer at all.

→ Con lo siguiente. H describe una torre lisa y sin adornos (a plain cone of timber, as smooth as he could make it). El párrafo siguiente la valora con un sustantivo resumen y la retoma: Simplicity served it well against the water, the cone stood unmoved.

Tentador: B. The remedy was to start again parece encajar tras la destrucción de la primera torre, pero more than twice as tall as Smeaton's da por conocido a alguien que todavía no ha aparecido, y en B no hay nada sencillo a lo que pueda referirse Simplicity served it well.

Teoría: §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás · §3.1 Hilo narrativo

40 · A · *The oldest of them, Henry Hall, was ninety-four.*

← Con lo anterior. El párrafo anterior deja en la torre a the three men on the rock, y A escoge a uno de ellos con un pronombre: The oldest of them, Henry Hall (§4.1).

→ Con lo siguiente. A presenta a Hall con nombre completo y cuenta su muerte (Hall died twelve days later); el párrafo siguiente lo nombra solo por el apellido: Hall's ordeal made him briefly famous. Ningún otro párrafo presenta a Hall (§3.4).

Teoría: §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás · §3.4 Progresión temática

41 · E · *He was equally original in his choice of materials.*

← Con lo anterior. El párrafo anterior explica la primera idea de Smeaton, la forma (found his answer in the shape of an oak). E añade otra: He was equally original in his choice of materials. La palabra equally presupone una primera muestra de originalidad, y He solo puede ser Smeaton.

→ Con lo siguiente. E describe bloques encajados entre sí (each block cut ashore to fit its neighbours, every course was locked to the one below). El párrafo siguiente lo resume con una nominalización y lo suma a la forma: It was the shape and the dovetailing together (§4.4).

Tentador: B. La mención de the dovetailed granite parece preparar the dovetailing del párrafo siguiente, pero B empieza con The remedy was to start again, y en ese punto no hay nada que remediar: Smeaton acaba de recibir el encargo. Además, B salta a 1882, y el párrafo siguiente vuelve a las décadas que siguieron a 1759 (Within decades it had become the model).

Teoría: §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás · §4.4 Cadenas léxicas

42 · B · *The remedy was to start again on a neighbouring…*

← Con lo anterior. El párrafo anterior plantea un problema que no se arregla reparando la torre: the rock beneath it was being worn away. B empieza con un sustantivo resumen que presenta la solución: The remedy was to start again on a neighbouring rock (§3.2, problema–solución).

→ Con lo siguiente. B presenta la torre nueva (The new tower, designed by James Douglass), y el párrafo siguiente la toma como punto de referencia con un posesivo: Its predecessor was not simply left to the waves. Its es la torre de Douglass, y predecessor, la de Smeaton.

Tentador: G. También habla de la torre nueva, pero The Douglass tower da por presentado a Douglass, que aparece por primera vez en B. Además, Its predecessor necesitaría delante la construcción de la torre nueva, y G empieza cuando ya lleva más de un siglo en servicio.

Teoría: §3.2 Hilo argumentativo · §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás

43 · G · *The Douglass tower is still in service, although nobody…*

← Con lo anterior. El párrafo anterior termina con los restos de la torre de Smeaton junto a la nueva (beside the newer tower). G pasa a esa torre, que ya conocemos: The Douglass tower is still in service. Douglass se presentó con nombre completo en el hueco 42 (designed by James Douglass).

→ Con lo siguiente. G termina con una condición: on days when the weather allows. El último párrafo la recoge con un sustantivo resumen, would have recognised that proviso, y la enlaza con las dificultades de Winstanley.

Teoría: §3.4 Progresión temática · §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás

El párrafo sobrante

D · *Winstanley lost no time in turning his achievement to…*

- **Hueco 37.** D nombra a Winstanley solo por el apellido (Winstanley lost no time), y en ese punto todavía no se ha presentado: lo hace F. Además, the finished tower aún no existe (§3.4).
- **Hueco 38.** Encaje por un solo lado. Por detrás funciona, porque turning his achievement to account puede seguir a la primera luz; pero el párrafo siguiente habla de the rebuilt tower, y D no menciona ninguna reforma. Además, ornate galleries and all presupone las galerías que añade la ampliación de C.
- **Huecos 39–43.** Cronología imposible: Winstanley muere en 1703 (no trace was ever found), y D lo presenta vivo, sacando partido de su torre. Del hueco 39 en adelante el relato ya va por Rudyerd, Smeaton y Douglass.

Teoría: §5.1 Cómo se fabrica el sobrante · §3.1 Hilo narrativo